FANGZHOU LIU (ANNE)

Financial Economist | AI, Causal Inference, and Product Innovation

Shanghai, China | +86 15000262175 | anne dot fzliu at gmail dot com |
https://liufangzhou-finance.github.io/

Professional Summary

Economist with a Ph.D. in Finance and eight years of post-Ph.D. experience conducting empirical research in economics and finance. Develops research questions and designs empirical studies at the intersection of AI and corporate finance, innovation, product markets, and corporate governance. Has extensive hands-on experience with causal inference and quasi-experimental research designs, large-scale structured and unstructured datasets, LLM-assisted data annotation, BERT-based text classification, barcode-level product innovation data, and firm-level financial data. Research has been presented at major international finance conferences, including the American Finance Association (AFA), Financial Management Association (FMA), Midwest Finance Association (MFA), and China International Conference in Finance (CICF). My papers have been accepted for publication in the Journal of Banking & Finance and the Journal of Empirical Finance.

Core Expertise

Causal inference: Difference-in-differences, stacked DiD, triple differences, event studies, regression discontinuity, instrumental variable and quasi-experimental designs, matching, and high-dimensional fixed effects.
AI and measurement: LLM APIs, prompt-based annotation, BERT/NLP classification, model training and validation, human-labeled datasets, unstructured-text measurement, and scalable firm-level indicator construction.
Data and computing: Stata, Python, SAS, and SQL; large-scale data cleaning, entity matching, statistical analysis, and reproducible empirical workflows.
Data domains: Earnings-call transcripts, consumer product launches, patents, firm financials, analyst forecasts, executive compensation, stock trading, short selling, bank loans, and public economic indicators.

Professional Experience

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (SUFE) — Assistant Professor of Finance **Oct 2018–Present**
Shanghai, China

- Lead research agendas on AI-enabled economic measurement, corporate innovation, information economics, and the effects of financial market relationships on product innovation decisions.
- Translate open-ended economic questions into measurable outcomes, identification strategies, and end-to-end empirical projects; manage research design, data engineering, econometric modeling, validation, writing, and delivery.
- Build and analyze high-dimensional datasets linking company disclosures, unstructured text, product launches, patents, firm financial and executive characteristics.
- Mentor more than 20 master's students and teach empirical corporate finance, advanced corporate finance, financial statement analysis, and research writing across undergraduate, master's, and doctoral programs; ranked in the university's top 1% for teaching evaluations three times.
- Invited to present research at Peking University, NYU Shanghai, Indiana University, Georgetown University, CICF, AFA, FMA, and MFA.
- Organized the 2023 and 2024 SUFE Summer Workshops on Corporate Finance and Capital Markets and chaired a session at the inaugural China Corporate Finance Summer Forum.

Fudan University International School of Finance — Adjunct Professor **2025–Present**
Shanghai, China

- Teach Financial Reporting and Security Analysis in an elite master's program.

Hong Kong Monetary Authority — Research Assistant **Oct 2011–Jun 2012**
Hong Kong

- Supported economists in monitoring macroeconomic and financial indicators and analyzing changes in housing prices, rents, and cross-market conditions in China and the United States.
- Constructed a contract-level dataset on entrusted lending by Chinese listed firms, extracting loan size, maturity, interest rates, and counterparties for research on non-bank credit.

Selected Research

Managerial Horizon: An LLM Approach
with Evgeny Lyandres and Chen Xu; CICF 2026

- Designed an LLM-based measure of managerial horizon from earnings-call transcripts to distinguish attention allocation to short-term operating performance from long-term strategy.
- Built a human-labeled corpus, used LLM-assisted annotation to expand training data, fine-tuned and validated a BERT classifier on 13,550 labeled passages, and classified more than 3 million passages at scale.
- Show that performance-focused managerial attention predicts lower subsequent R&D, capital expenditure, patenting, and long-run underperformance.

The Impact of Banking Deregulation on Competition and Product Innovation
Sole author; Journal of Empirical Finance, conditionally accepted

- Constructed barcode-level data spanning 32 consumer markets and 81 product categories and applied stacked DiD and triple-difference models to identify heterogeneous effects by competitive position.
- Find that banking deregulation increases breakthrough innovation among market leaders but reduces innovation among followers, revealing how financing and competition jointly shape product strategy.

Information Spillovers and Cross Monitoring Between the Stock Market and Loan Market
with Matt Billett and Xuan Tian; Journal of Banking & Finance, 2025; corresponding author

- Used the Regulation SHO pilot program as an exogenous shock to short-selling constraints and integrated trading, short-interest, bank-loan, and ownership data to identify cross-market information effects.
- Show that bank monitoring changes information production and investor responses in equity markets.

Analyst Coverage and Innovation: Evidence from New Product Introductions
Sole author; MFA Annual Meeting

- Combined barcode-level product launches with analyst, firm, and market data; used brokerage closures and mergers as plausibly exogenous variation in analyst coverage.
- Applied LLM-based analysis to earnings-call Q&A to measure analyst attention to radical innovation; show that this attention predicts subsequent breakthrough products and stronger announcement returns.

Financial Constraints and the Cyclicality of New Product Introductions
Sole author; AFA AFFECT Mentoring Workshop 2025; sponsored by Shanghai Pujiang Talent Program

- Studies how macroeconomic fluctuations and financing constraints shape breakthrough versus incremental product innovation.

Ad-hoc Referee

Journal of Banking and Finance | Journal of Corporate Finance | Pacific-basin Finance Journal | China Finance Review International (CFRI)

Education

Indiana University, Kelley School of Business — Ph.D. in Finance 2012–2018
The Chinese University of Hong Kong — B.Sc. in Quantitative Finance 2008–2012

Awards

Shanghai Pujiang Talent Program | Kelley School of Business Fellowship | AFA Travel Grant

Grants

SUFE Pre-Research Fund for Young Researchers, RMB 30,000 2022
Pujiang Talent Program, RMB 150,000 2020
SUFE Start-up Fund for Young Researchers, RMB 90,000 2018